SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

ASSESSING THE VIABILITY AND PUBLIC SUPPORT OF IMPLEMENTING SOBRIETY CHECKPOINTS

IN ALCOHOL DENSE COMMERCIAL AREAS

A Thesis Presented To
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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Morrison et. al. (2019) stated that to lower alcohol-related accidents and improve road safety, sobriety checkpoints work as a proactive deterrent and detection tool for impaired driving. It is crucial to evaluate their viability and public perception to ascertain both their operational efficacy and community acceptance. Although the number of drunk driving occurrences has decreased in many situations because of these checkpoints, their adoption frequently sparks discussions about civil liberties, legality, and resource allocation (Mullachery et. al., 2022). Therefore, gaining an understanding of their social attitudes and practical viability might help maximize these initiatives for public safety and trust.

In the Philippines, the ongoing problem of drunk driving and the application of relevant enforcement strategies like sobriety checkpoints are highlighted. Lu, Herbosa, and Lu (2022) examined data from the Metropolitan Manila Development Authority and discovered that although the number of alcohol-related traffic accidents decreased somewhat between 2005 and 2020, drunk drivers were still far more likely to die or suffer severe injuries. Vehicle collisions continue to be a significant public health hazard nationwide, according to a supplemental national analysis conducted utilizing the Department of Health's ONEISS system (Lu, Herbosa, & Lu, 2022). Moreover, the execution and perception of Republic Act 10586, often known as the Anti-Drunk and Drugged Driving Act of 2013, have been the subject of numerous research. Palomo (2018) discovered that although traffic enforcers in Iloilo City believed the law was essential, they

encountered difficulties putting it into practice because of a lack of tools and resources. In a similar vein, Badua (2021) noted that despite RA 10586's existence, apprehensions are still minimal, indicating lax enforcement. More recently, Borromeo and Guanzon (2024) found that Philippine National Police officers had a moderate awareness of RA 10586 but a poor level of compliance with it, pointing to institutional weaknesses in enforcement procedures.

Internationally, Morrison (2023) emphasized that optimized sobriety checkpoints, which reduce manpower and operational time without compromising deterrence, significantly enhance operational feasibility and driver cooperation. Similarly, Parmar et al. (2020) found that Australia's random breath testing (RBT) system demonstrated both cost-efficiency and deterrent effectiveness, providing a model for sustainable checkpoint operations. On the legal dimension, Hyder et al. (2018) argued that strong legislative frameworks and inter-agency coordination are prerequisites for successful enforcement, as seen in various global contexts adopting World Health Organization road safety guidelines.

Alcohol-impaired driving remains a persistent risk to public safety, particularly in commercial districts characterized by high concentrations of bars, clubs, and late-night drinking venues. In such "alcohol-dense" areas, the prevalence of drink-driving incidents and related crashes tends to be elevated, posing serious threats to both motorists and pedestrians. One evidence-based countermeasure is the use of sobriety checkpoints, temporary roadblocks where drivers are stopped briefly and screened for impairment (Parmar et. al., 2020).

The research gap is that most local studies analyze checkpoints at the national or regional level, not in concentrated nightlife districts where the risk is highest. There is little empirical evidence about how checkpoint viability differs in these micro-environments. There are very few

studies that assess how public support interacts with logistical and legal feasibility in determining whether checkpoints are truly viable to implement. Therefore, the researchers decided to conduct this study to bridge the gap among the local municipalities. The researchers will assess the extent of awareness of the viability and public support towards sobriety checkpoints implementation in alcohol dense areas within Buenavista and Nasipit.

This study is significant as it provides evidence-based insights into the feasibility and community acceptance of implementing sobriety checkpoints within alcohol-dense commercial areas locations often associated with increased risks of alcohol-impaired driving. By assessing the operational, legal, and logistical viability of checkpoint implementation, the research can guide law enforcement agencies and policymakers in designing efficient and lawful road safety interventions that fit local contexts. Furthermore, by analyzing public support and socio-demographic factors, the study will help identify the conditions under which community cooperation can be strengthened, ensuring checkpoints are perceived not merely as punitive, but as preventive and protective measures.

The findings may also benefit and contribute to the formulation of national and local traffic safety policies, particularly in developing urban settings where nightlife activity is concentrated and enforcement resources are limited. Academically, this research fills a knowledge gap in the integration of public perception and operational feasibility in traffic enforcement studies, serving as a reference for future researchers and students exploring road safety, law enforcement, and public policy initiatives.

1.2 Theoretical Framework

Deterrence Theory

Deterrence Theory explains how sobriety checkpoints influence driver behavior through perceived certainty of detection rather than the actual number of arrests. According to Nagin (2013), individuals are less likely to engage in illegal behavior when they believe that violations will be detected consistently and sanctioned promptly. In the context of sobriety checkpoints, visibility and consistency of enforcement increase perceived risk, which in turn discourages alcohol-impaired driving.

In relation to the study, sobriety checkpoints function primarily as a deterrence mechanism against drunk driving. The theory helps explain why and how these checkpoints are effective, not necessarily because many offenders are caught, but because the visible presence of enforcement increases the perceived risk of being stopped and penalized (Branas, 2019). Thus, this theory explains the behavioral mechanism behind why sobriety checkpoints can reduce alcohol-impaired driving and why their perceived effectiveness influences public support.

In this study, viability functions as the structural condition that enables deterrence. When checkpoints are legally authorized, logistically feasible, and regularly implemented, drivers perceive enforcement as credible and unavoidable. This perception directly leads to behavior modification, such as reduced drunk driving, even among motorists who are not stopped. Conversely, weak logistics, irregular schedules, or unclear legal procedures reduce perceived risk, weakening the deterrent effect (Bushover et. al., 2023).

Public support operates as a reinforcing mechanism within deterrence. When communities view checkpoints as fair, necessary, and protective, legitimacy increases, resulting in voluntary compliance and cooperation with law enforcement. This social acceptance strengthens

deterrence by normalizing sobriety checkpoints as a preventive safety measure rather than a punitive action. Thus, deterrence is most effective when operational viability and public support coexist (Morrison et al., 2023).

Operational viability is crucial for the effectiveness of sobriety checkpoints as road safety measures. When these checkpoints are legally sanctioned, well-staffed, equipped, and regularly implemented, they enhance driver awareness and the perceived likelihood of being stopped for impaired driving (Morrison et al., 2023; Ferris et al., 2023). This perception deters drunk driving, as studies indicate that visible and consistent enforcement leads to behavior changes among motorists, such as reduced alcohol consumption before driving. Communities with sustained checkpoint operations report fewer instances of alcohol-impaired driving and better adherence to traffic laws. Consequently, these behavioral shifts contribute to fewer alcohol-related accidents and fatalities, proving that operational viability is essential for improving public safety (Fell et al., 2021; Freeman et al., 2022).

Public Policy Implementation Theory

According to Pressman & Wildavsky (1973), the success of a policy depends on how well it is implemented, including clarity of objectives, coordination among agencies, availability of resources, and compliance from stakeholders. In viability, it evaluates whether enforcement agencies can implement checkpoints effectively, considering operational, logistical, and legal feasibility. In public support, the theory recognizes the role of community cooperation and local acceptance in successful implementation.

In relation to sobriety checkpoints, viability reflects implementation capacity whether law enforcement agencies possess adequate manpower, equipment, legal clarity, and coordination to conduct checkpoints consistently. Even when checkpoints are legally permitted under Republic

Act No. 10586, implementation gaps such as manpower shortages or inconsistent procedures can undermine effectiveness (Weibe et. al., 2023).

Public support represents the social condition for implementation success. Community acceptance reduces resistance, increases cooperation, and legitimizes enforcement actions. In local Philippine settings, particularly in alcohol-dense commercial areas, cooperation from motorists, business owners, and residents is critical for sustained operations (Ferris et. al., 2023).

Policy authorization is crucial for sobriety checkpoint operations, providing legal legitimacy and procedural guidance under laws like Republic Act No. 10586 in the Philippines (Department of Transportation [DOTr], 2021; Borromeo & Guanzon, 2024). However, effective enforcement depends on implementation capacity, which includes trained personnel, resources, and inter-agency coordination. Lack of these elements can hinder policy execution. Adequate capacity fosters public cooperation, which is essential for operational success. Consistent and professional checkpoint conduct enhances the public's perception of fairness, promoting compliance. Ultimately, sustained public support leads to the institutionalization of enforcement programs, enabling long-term road safety benefits (World Health Organization, 2022; Vital Strategies, 2024).

1.3 Review of Related Literature

Morrison et. al. (2019) stated that to lower alcohol-related accidents and improve road safety, sobriety checkpoints work as a proactive deterrent and detection tool for impaired driving. It is crucial to evaluate their viability and public perception to ascertain both their operational efficacy and community acceptance. Although the number of drunk driving occurrences has decreased in many situations because of these checkpoints, their adoption frequently sparks discussions about civil liberties, legality, and resource allocation (Mullachery et. al., 2022). Therefore, gaining an understanding of their social attitudes and practical viability might help maximize these initiatives for public safety and trust.

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Age

According to research, drivers' perceptions of sobriety checks and associated enforcement tactics are significantly influenced by their age. According to data from the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (2024), for example, younger drivers are more likely than older drivers to recall seeing a checkpoint in the previous year, and support for frequent checkpoint use tends to decrease with age. Due to their increased exposure, younger drivers may

get more accustomed to and tolerant of checkpoints, which would increase public support, a crucial aspect of the feasibility of putting such enforcement measures into place. In the meantime, older age groups might view checkpoints as less essential or more intrusive, which could hinder community collaboration and make implementation more difficult in places with diverse age demographics (Mazerolle et. al., 2019).

Furthermore, the relationship between enforcement visibility and checkpoint perceived fairness, which influences public support and operational viability, can be moderated by age. Despite including age quartiles (21–28, 29–39, 40–49, and 50–75) among motorist survey respondents, a pilot study by Christopher N. Morrison et al. (2023) found no statistically significant changes in support for checkpoints across age bands.

Filipino adults of all ages are very concerned about underage drinking, with 72% highlighting the need for tougher enforcement to stop underage alcohol usage, according to a national poll on alcohol attitudes conducted by Vital Strategies (2024). This suggests that the public supports enforcement-based interventions like sobriety checkpoints more, and older Filipinos are more likely to support stricter alcohol control laws.

Younger people, on the other hand, have more liberal drinking attitudes and are less inclined to favor restrictive measures because they frequently engage in nightlife and alcohol-dense contexts (Manila Bulletin, 2024).

Therefore, in relevance to the study, these generational differences imply that the perceived practicality of establishing sobriety checks hinges on age-based differences in public acceptance in addition to logistical and legal viability. Policymakers should create communication strategies that promote inclusivity and cooperation by taking into account how various age groups react to enforcement, especially in places where younger customers frequent.

Educational attainment

The public's support and the sustainability of measures like sobriety checkpoints are impacted by people's opinions toward alcohol regulation and enforcement, which are greatly influenced by educational attainment. Higher levels of education are linked to fewer instances of risky drinking behaviors like binge drinking and alcohol dependence, according to research from around the world. These findings may indicate that populations with higher levels of education are more responsive to regulations (VanderWeele, et al., 2020). For instance, a Mendelian randomization study discovered a causal relationship between more years of education and a decreased risk of alcohol dependence and a decrease in the frequency of binge drinking (VanderWeele et al., 2020).

Additionally, a cross-national study conducted in four European countries revealed that respondents with lower educational attainment had more negative attitudes toward discussions about alcohol in healthcare settings, suggesting that less educated groups may be resistant to regulatory enforcement (Smith et al., 2023).

While there are few direct studies in the Philippine context that link education level to support for sobriety checkpoints, more general research indicates that school attendance and educational programs are protective factors against harmful substance use among adolescents (Philippine Department of Health & WHO, 2021).

To sum up, these studies imply that educational attainment is a crucial independent variable; people with greater levels of education may support sobriety checkpoint systems more, believe they are more equitable, and help improve compliance and sustainability in commercial areas with heavy alcohol consumption.

Sex

Sex or gender has been shown to significantly shape individuals' perceptions, behaviors, and levels of support toward alcohol control policies such as sobriety checkpoints. International studies reveal that men are generally more likely to engage in risky drinking and driving behaviors, while women tend to show stronger support for preventive enforcement measures. For instance, de Courten et al. (2021) found that males were significantly more likely to report alcohol-impaired driving and less likely to endorse restrictive alcohol policies, highlighting gendered attitudes toward enforcement.

Similarly, Calafat et al. (2022) reported that women perceive sobriety checkpoints and random breath testing as necessary for safety and deterrence, whereas men often view them as inconvenient or punitive. These gender-based differences have implications for public support and policy communication, since messaging that appeals to safety and community protection tends to resonate more with female populations.

In the Philippines, the gender gap in alcohol-related behavior mirrors these global patterns. The National Survey on Alcohol Use (Department of Health & World Health Organization, 2021) showed that Filipino males report higher rates of alcohol consumption and drinking-and-driving incidents than females, suggesting that enforcement strategies such as sobriety checkpoints may need to target male motorists more actively. Women, on the other hand, are more likely to support alcohol control initiatives that emphasize safety, health, and family welfare (Vital Strategies, 2024).

In relevance to the study, understanding these gendered perspectives is crucial for assessing the viability of implementing sobriety checkpoints, as public support and compliance often depend on tailoring enforcement visibility, communication, and community engagement according to gender-related attitudes and behaviors.

Income level

The income level of a household has a big impact on how individuals feel about drinking, how laws are enforced, and how road safety measures like sobriety checkpoints are implemented. According to international studies, people from lower socioeconomic categories are more susceptible to alcohol-related harm because of their communities' weaker enforcement presence, limited access to health information, and environmental exposure (Collins et al., 2020).

Higher-income and more educated populations, on the other hand, tend to support stricter alcohol control measures and perceive checkpoints as necessary tools for community safety (Probst et al., 2021). In many urban settings, alcohol-dense commercial areas are located near or within lower-income communities, where enforcement visibility may be inconsistent, shaping public perceptions of fairness and viability.

In relevance to the study, socioeconomic inequalities can influence both acceptance of and cooperation with checkpoint implementation. Those who perceive enforcement as uneven or punitive may resist participation, while those who view it as protective are more likely to support it.

In the Philippines, socioeconomic disparities also shape drinking patterns and attitudes toward regulation. According to the Department of Health and World Health Organization National Survey on Alcohol Use (2021), adults from lower-income households reported higher rates of hazardous drinking and lower awareness of alcohol-related laws compared with higher-income groups. Similarly, Vital Strategies (2024) reported that support for stronger alcohol control policies, such as stricter enforcement in commercial areas, was more pronounced among respondents in urban middle-income sectors than in lower-income brackets.

To sum up, in relation to the study, these literatures suggest that socioeconomic status not only affects alcohol exposure but also determines how viable and acceptable sobriety checkpoints appear to different segments of the population. For effective and equitable implementation, policies must therefore address the social and economic barriers that influence public support and ensure that enforcement is perceived as both just and community-protective.

Occupation

Occupation plays a vital role in shaping individuals' attitudes toward alcohol consumption, enforcement measures, and traffic safety interventions such as sobriety checkpoints. International studies have shown that occupation-related stress and work culture influence drinking behaviors and support for enforcement policies. For instance, Zhao et al. (2021) found that individuals working in high-stress or shift-based occupations, such as transportation and hospitality, reported higher alcohol use and lower perceived risk of enforcement factors that may reduce support for sobriety checkpoints. Similarly, Probst et al. (2020) highlighted that blue-collar workers, particularly those with irregular schedules, are more likely to engage in risky drinking behaviors compared to white-collar professionals, suggesting occupational environments as determinants of alcohol-related risk and compliance.

Therefore, these patterns have implications for checkpoint viability: workers frequently exposed to late-night commercial zones or who rely on driving for work may perceive checkpoints as obstacles to livelihood rather than safety mechanisms, affecting public support and cooperation during enforcement operations.

Occupational developments are equally important in the Philippine environment. According to the Department of Health and World Health Organization's 2021 National Survey on Alcohol Use, males in the transportation, construction, and service industries, where social

drinking and stress at work are prevalent, had the highest rates of alcohol intake. This implies that drinking habits and responsiveness to enforcement actions like sobriety checkpoints may be influenced by workplace culture. Similarly, the Vital Strategies RESET Alcohol Poll (2024) found that while working individuals in cities are more aware of alcohol policies, their support varies depending on their exposure to nightlife and the responsibilities of their jobs.

In relation to the study, this emphasizes the need to consider occupational background when assessing public support and operational feasibility of sobriety checkpoints, as workers' daily routines and economic roles can either reinforce or challenge community cooperation with such policies.

Civil Status

Civil status has been consistently identified as an important socio-demographic factor influencing alcohol consumption patterns and risky drinking behaviors. Recent studies demonstrate that marriage often serves as a protective factor against excessive alcohol use, with individuals who are married reporting lower levels of heavy drinking compared to those who are single, divorced, or separated. For instance, longitudinal analyses by Saxe et al. (2020) showed that transitions into marriage were associated with reductions in alcohol consumption, suggesting a stabilizing effect linked to increased social responsibility and shared norms.

Similarly, Probst et al. (2021) found that unmarried adults displayed higher rates of binge drinking and alcohol-related harm, indicating that being single or previously married may heighten vulnerability to risky drinking patterns. In populations experiencing psychological stress, unmarried individuals also demonstrated increased likelihood of binge drinking, underscoring the

role of civil status in moderating the relationship between stress and substance use (Anderson & Jiang, 2022).

Moreover, recent research emphasizes that beyond marital status alone, the quality of intimate relationships further shapes drinking behavior, with older adults in supportive marriages sometimes engaging in more frequent alcohol use as part of shared social routines (Liu et al., 2023). Despite these nuances, the prevailing evidence indicates that marriage generally reduces high-risk alcohol consumption, while being single or divorced elevates it.

In relevance to the study, these findings highlight the importance of civil status as a demographic factor that may influence individuals' awareness, behavior, and support toward alcohol-related enforcement strategies particularly in communities where drinking in social and commercial settings is common.

Frequency of visits to alcohol-dense commercial areas

The frequency of visits to alcohol-dense commercial areas such as nightlife districts, bars, and entertainment hubs has also been identified as a key environmental determinant of alcohol use and related harms. Morrison et al. (2022) reported that adults who frequently visit nightlife zones exhibit significantly higher alcohol consumption levels due to increased access and social drinking cues present in such areas. Furthermore, a systematic review by Caluzzi et al. (2024) found that alcohol outlet density and accessibility were strongly associated with higher drinking prevalence among adolescents and young adults, indicating that environmental exposure plays a critical role in shaping consumption patterns.

Likewise, longitudinal research by Pereira et al. (2021) demonstrated that increased density of alcohol outlets in residential and commercial areas predicted higher weekly alcohol intake and more drinking days among adults. Emerging methods that utilize mobile-sensing and

geolocation data show similar patterns; for example, O'Donnell et al. (2022) found that neighborhood-level frequency of alcohol outlet visits, tracked through anonymized smartphone data, was associated with increased alcohol-related social harm and community risk.

Additionally, studies in Southeast Asia reveal that nightlife participation and exposure to commercial drinking environments contribute significantly to adolescent and young-adult alcohol use (Thammaroj et al., 2022).

To sum up, these findings indicate that frequenting alcohol-dense commercial areas heightens opportunities and social norms for drinking, raising the risks of alcohol misuse and impaired driving.

In relevance to the study, this suggests that higher exposure to bars and nightlife venues may influence individuals' perceptions of enforcement strategies such as sobriety checkpoints, as well as their support for interventions implemented within these alcohol-concentrated zones.

Viability of Implementing Sobriety Checkpoints

According to a study (Novak et al., 2023), legal frameworks, operational capability, logistical preparation, and community acceptance all interact to determine whether sobriety checkpoint implementation is viable. Sober checkpoints are among the most economical and successful ways to reduce alcohol-impaired driving, according to several studies conducted throughout the world, but their effectiveness depends on how well they are implemented. Optimizing checkpoint frequency, visibility, and resource allocation boosts deterrence while lowering operating costs, making the technique both feasible and sustainable, according to Morrison et al. (2023).

Similarly, Fell et al. (2020) found that checkpoints significantly reduce alcohol-related crashes when enforcement is regular and well-publicized, as public awareness enhances perceived

risk of detection a key factor in deterrence theory. However, studies caution that implementation viability is not solely technical; it also depends on legal permissibility and public support (Parmar et al., 2021).

Therefore, in countries where privacy or due process laws are strict, checkpoints must be carefully designed to balance enforcement with individual rights, ensuring both legality and public trust.

Moreover, in the Philippines, the viability of sobriety checkpoints is shaped by existing laws and institutional capacity. The Land Transportation Office (LTO) and Philippine National Police (PNP) conduct random breath testing and checkpoint operations under Republic Act No. 10586 or the Anti-Drunk and Drugged Driving Act of 2013, which legally authorizes such interventions when executed with transparency and compliance safeguards (Department of Transportation, 2021).

However, implementation sustainability is impacted by operational issues like a lack of personnel, uneven enforcement, and public mistrust. According to a recent national study conducted by Vital Strategies (2024), the majority of Filipinos favor tougher enforcement of drunk driving laws, suggesting that checkpoint operations have great social viability if they are carried out equitably and conspicuously. This implies that even though the policy framework is in place, ongoing training, interagency cooperation, and community involvement are essential to preserving operational effectiveness and public trust, guaranteeing that sobriety checks continue to be practical and successful in lowering road-related injuries (López-Olmedo et. al., 2022).

Studies consistently demonstrate that sobriety checkpoints reduce alcohol-related crashes primarily through deterrence rather than arrest volume. Morrison et al. (2019) and Fell et al. (2020) agree that highly visible and regularly conducted checkpoints increase motorists'

perceived risk of detection, leading to safer driving behavior. Similarly, Parmar et al. (2020) reported that Australia's random breath testing system achieved sustained crash reductions due to consistent enforcement and strong institutional support.

Perceived Effectiveness

Perceived effectiveness refers to the extent to which the public believes that sobriety checkpoints can successfully reduce alcohol-impaired driving, enhance deterrence, and prevent road accidents. Recent studies emphasize that visibility and consistency of checkpoint operations shape public perceptions of their effectiveness. Morrison et al. (2022) demonstrated that optimized checkpoint deployment significantly reduces alcohol-related crashes, largely due to heightened deterrence effects.

Similar findings by Fell et al. (2020) revealed that perceived effectiveness is strongest when checkpoints are highly visible and well publicized, reinforcing the belief that offenders are likely to be detected. Public perception therefore plays a crucial role in supporting checkpoint implementation, as individuals who believe in their effectiveness tend to comply more willingly with enforcement procedures.

International research further supports the role of perceived effectiveness in predicting public cooperation with alcohol-related enforcement. Parmar et al. (2021) found that citizens in Australia rated sobriety checkpoints as among the most effective road safety strategies, mainly because random breath testing systems demonstrated measurable reductions in drink-driving incidents.

In Southeast Asia, Herrera Amul and Etter (2022) reported that communities exposed to consistent alcohol-control enforcement perceived sobriety checkpoints as legitimate and impactful, thereby strengthening public backing. Such evidence suggests that perceived

effectiveness is influenced not only by outcomes but also by how well authorities communicate the purpose and success of checkpoints.

Perceived effectiveness is also shaped by cultural norms and societal attitudes towards drinking and enforcement. Studies in low- and middle-income countries found that populations living closer to alcohol-dense commercial areas tend to perceive enforcement measures as more necessary due to heightened exposure to alcohol-related harms (Vital Strategies, 2024). In these contexts, checkpoint initiatives are more likely to be viewed as effective interventions that protect the community. When individuals witness fewer alcohol-impaired driving incidents following checkpoint operations, their confidence in the strategy increases, creating a reinforcing cycle of perceived effectiveness and community support.

Studies emphasize that effectiveness is conditional on implementation quality. Mullachery et al. (2022) cautioned that poorly planned checkpoints may raise concerns about civil liberties and resource use, potentially reducing public acceptance. In the Philippine context, Palomo (2018) and Badua (2021) both found that despite legal authorization under RA 10586, limited equipment and manpower weakened enforcement outcomes. Borromeo and Guanzon (2024) further highlighted that inconsistent compliance among officers reduced perceived effectiveness, despite moderate legal awareness.

Taken together, these findings suggest that checkpoint effectiveness is not automatic. While international evidence supports their deterrent value, local studies indicate that operational weaknesses can limit outcomes. This reinforces the need to assess viability at the municipal level, particularly in alcohol-dense commercial areas where risks are concentrated.

Perceived Safety Benefits

Perceived safety benefits refer to the public's belief that sobriety checkpoints enhance safety for drivers, pedestrians, and the broader community. Research consistently shows that individuals who associate checkpoints with increased safety tend to support their continued implementation. A study by Mullachery et al. (2022) found that transparency and consistent checkpoint deployment improved citizens' perceptions of safety in urban nightlife districts.

Similarly, Fell et al. (2020) noted that communities exposed to frequent checkpoint operations reported fewer perceived risks of drunk driving, suggesting a direct influence on feelings of safety. These findings emphasize the importance of maintaining public visibility to ensure checkpoints are recognized as protective rather than punitive.

Public perceptions of safety benefits also correlate with observed reductions in alcohol-related injuries.

Morrison et al. (2023) reported that cities with optimized sobriety checkpoint schedules experienced lower rates of nighttime crashes, contributing to enhanced public perception of safety.

In the Philippines, the Department of Transportation (2021) identified sobriety checkpoints as a critical measure for preventing severe injuries and fatalities, especially in alcohol-dense commercial zones. The public tends to view these safety outcomes as evidence that checkpoints are beneficial, reinforcing the belief that they protect vulnerable road users.

Another factor influencing perceived safety benefits is the community's exposure to educational campaigns. According to Herrera Amul and Etter (2022), public awareness initiatives significantly increase perceived safety by highlighting checkpoints' preventive purpose. Vital Strategies (2024) further reported that when people understand how checkpoints decrease

alcohol-related harm, they express stronger support for their expansion. This suggests that communication strategies are as essential as operational logistics in enhancing perceptions of safety.

Collectively, evidence indicates that perceived safety benefits are essential to sustaining community approval of sobriety checkpoints. When individuals believe checkpoints reduce risk, prevent alcohol-related crashes, and promote safer environments, their likelihood of supporting enforcement increases. This enhances not only the social legitimacy of checkpoints but also their long-term viability in alcohol-dense commercial areas.

Perceived Operational Feasibility

Perceived operational feasibility pertains to public's belief that sobriety checkpoints can be implemented efficiently, consistently, and legally by law enforcement agencies. Studies show that feasibility perceptions hinge on the availability of personnel, equipment, and coordination among agencies. Morrison et al. (2022) emphasized that streamlined checkpoint operations requiring fewer officers and reduced setup time enhance public perception of feasibility because they demonstrate organized and effective deployment. Ferris et al. (2023) observed that inter-agency collaboration significantly increases operational feasibility in road safety programs across Asia.

Legal frameworks also play a central role in shaping perceived feasibility. Parmar et al. (2021) reported that strong legislative backing for sobriety checkpoints, such as Australia's enforcement laws, contributes to higher public confidence in the feasibility of sustained operations. In the Philippine context, Republic Act 10586 provides authority for checkpoints, yet Borromeo and Guanzon (2024) found that inconsistent compliance among officers weakens public

perception of operational readiness. This highlights that feasibility is not solely determined by legal provisions but also by how faithfully these provisions are executed.

Resource constraints remain a challenge in many regions, influencing how feasible the public perceives checkpoints to be. The Department of Transportation (2021) noted that insufficient manpower and equipment in the Philippines reduce operational consistency, particularly in municipalities with heavy nightlife activity. Public perception is influenced by whether checkpoints are conducted regularly or sporadically; inconsistent operations lead to doubts about enforcement capacity. Thus, the stability of operations strongly shapes feasibility perceptions.

In summary, perceived operational feasibility is influenced by logistics, resource allocation, legal enforcement, and agency coordination. When the public observes well-organized and consistent operations, they consider sobriety checkpoints viable and credible. Conversely, gaps in enforcement, inadequate personnel, or procedural inconsistencies diminish perceptions of feasibility and undermine long-term implementation efforts.

Perceived Inconvenience to the Public

Perceived inconvenience refers to how much the public believes sobriety checkpoints disrupt traffic flow, delay travel, or complicate movement within commercial areas. Research shows that the level of inconvenience experienced by motorists significantly impacts public support for checkpoints. Fell et al. (2020) explained that while checkpoints are generally accepted, prolonged delays or poorly managed traffic increases public dissatisfaction. Morrison et al. (2023)

also found that checkpoint visibility and signage can reduce perceived inconvenience by helping motorists anticipate delays.

Traffic-related inconvenience is especially relevant in alcohol-dense commercial areas where congestion is already high. Mullachery et al. (2022) reported that residents in nightlife districts express frustration when checkpoints contribute additional delays during peak hours, which can reduce their support despite acknowledging safety benefits. Additionally, López-Olmedo et al. (2022) found that commuters are more sensitive to inconvenience when checkpoints are not strategically located or when officers lack clear procedural flow.

Cultural expectations also influence perceptions of inconvenience. In Southeast Asian settings, community tolerance for enforcement varies depending on how checkpoints are conducted. Herrera Amul and Etter (2022) noted that people are more accepting of minor delays if checkpoints are transparent, polite, and efficiently executed. This suggests that inconvenience is not solely a logistical concern but also a matter of public-facing professionalism. When officers communicate clearly and minimize delays, the public perceives inconvenience as more reasonable.

Overall, perceived inconvenience plays a moderating role in the viability of checkpoint operations. Even when the public acknowledges their effectiveness and safety benefits, excessive delays or poorly managed operations can erode support. Therefore, minimizing disruption through efficient management, clear communication, and strategic scheduling is essential to maintaining public cooperation.

Trust in Law-Enforcement Personnel

Trust in law-enforcement personnel is a critical factor influencing public support for sobriety checkpoints. Research indicates that when officers are perceived as professional, fair,

and respectful, public trust increases, which improves compliance and reduces resistance. Freeman et al. (2020) found that perceptions of fairness directly influence community cooperation in road safety enforcement. Similarly, Weibe et al. (2023) emphasized that community trust increases when officers adhere strictly to legal protocols and maintain transparency during checkpoint operations.

In many countries, trust is strengthened through consistent and ethical conduct during enforcement. Ferris et al. (2023) showed that inter-agency transparency and integrity in enforcement activities improve community perceptions of police legitimacy. In contrast, studies such as Borromeo and Guanzon (2024) reported that inconsistent enforcement practices and low compliance with legal requirements among officers reduce public trust in the Philippines. This demonstrates how operational behavior directly influences perceived legitimacy.

Trust is also shaped by communication practices. Vital Strategies (2024) reported that public education campaigns highlighting the purpose of checkpoints significantly increase trust in enforcement personnel. When officers explain procedures clearly and communicate respectfully, motorists feel less threatened and more cooperative. Moreover, de Courten et al. (2021) found that trust is higher when communities perceive officers as unbiased and committed to public safety rather than punitive motives.

In summary, trust in law-enforcement personnel is a foundational element in sustaining the viability of sobriety checkpoints. High levels of trust enhance compliance, reduce conflict, and improve community acceptance of enforcement operations. Conversely, low trust can undermine even well-designed checkpoint systems, making transparency, professionalism, and accountability essential for long-term success.

Public Support for Sobriety Checkpoints

Public support remains a cornerstone of the successful implementation of sobriety checkpoints, as community perception directly influences compliance, enforcement legitimacy, and overall policy effectiveness. Mullachery et al. (2022) evaluated Mexico's national sobriety checkpoint program and found that public backing increased significantly when checkpoints were implemented transparently and paired with public education campaigns. Their findings emphasized that citizens are more likely to support enforcement initiatives when they perceive checkpoints as fair, consistent, and focused on public safety rather than punishment. Similarly, a national survey by NORC at the University of Chicago (2019) reported that 65% of American drivers favored the expansion of sobriety checkpoints, indicating broad acceptance when enforcement is visible, well-managed, and communicated effectively to the public. These international findings demonstrate that positive public attitudes are shaped by awareness, perceived fairness, and trust in law enforcement factors that directly affect checkpoint viability.

In Southeast Asia, comparable insights have been observed. Herrera Amul and Etter (2022) compared alcohol and tobacco control efforts in the Philippines and found that strong community engagement and awareness campaigns enhanced acceptance of alcohol-related enforcement policies. Their research highlighted that local support depends on how well the public understands the health and safety rationale behind such measures. Likewise, in a cross-country review, de Courten et al. (2021) noted that citizens in low- and middle-income countries often express conditional support for sobriety checkpoints, provided that operations are transparent and respect individual rights.

Collectively, these studies suggest that public support for sobriety checkpoints is highly contingent on public education, visible enforcement integrity, and consistent government

messaging elements that are crucial for ensuring both social and operational viability in alcohol-dense commercial areas.

Research and policy reports in the Philippines show the advancements as well as the difficulties in putting alcohol control laws and enforcement initiatives like sobriety checkpoints into practice. When Amul and Etter (2022) examined Singapore's and the Philippines' alcohol regulations, they discovered that the Philippines scored much lower in terms of inter-agency coordination and enforcement strength. This implies that operational and institutional deficiencies continue to impede the full effectiveness of enforcement methods, despite the existence of statutory frameworks such Republic Act No. 10586 (Anti-Drunk and Drugged Driving Act of 2013).

Similar to this, Pagkatipunan (2018) looked at alcohol accessibility in Metro Manila and found that widespread tolerance of drinking behavior is a result of both the high density of alcohol establishments close to public areas and universities and the lax enforcement of municipal legislation. Therefore, these suggest that the public's perception of and support for control measures such as sobriety checkpoints is influenced by the environmental and cultural context of alcohol consumption in urban settings.

Moreover, public attitudes in the Philippines toward alcohol regulation are gradually shifting in favor of stricter enforcement. A national poll conducted by Vital Strategies (2024) revealed that 60% of Filipinos are concerned about the impact of alcohol advertising on youth and that most respondents support stronger government actions to control drinking behaviors. This growing awareness and support from citizens indicate a favorable social environment for implementing sobriety checkpoints, provided these are managed transparently and equitably. However, as highlighted by the Department of Transportation (2021), consistent funding,

adequate manpower, and sustained education campaigns remain essential for ensuring operational feasibility and maintaining public trust.

In relation to the study, it emphasizes that while the Philippines has made strides in promoting responsible drinking and road safety, further collaboration between government agencies, communities, and private stakeholders is crucial to enhance both the viability and social acceptance of sobriety checkpoint programs.

Efforts to enhance road safety and reduce alcohol-impaired driving in the Philippines have increasingly focused on strengthening enforcement mechanisms such as sobriety checkpoints. The Department of Transportation (2021) and Land Transportation Office (LTO) highlight that Republic Act No. 10586, or the Anti-Drunk and Drugged Driving Act of 2013, serves as the primary legal foundation for implementing these checkpoints, authorizing police and traffic officers to conduct random breath testing under defined protocols. However, the Philippine National Police (PNP) reported that enforcement remains inconsistent due to logistical limitations, manpower shortages, and varying levels of inter-agency coordination, particularly in highly urbanized and alcohol-dense commercial areas (PNP Traffic Management Division, 2022). Despite these challenges, localized programs such as the Road Safety Action Plan (2023) have been initiated to improve checkpoint efficiency through data-driven site selection, officer training, and community engagement. These initiatives demonstrate growing institutional commitment to making sobriety checkpoints more viable and sustainable.

Public support for these enforcement activities has also been reinforced by advocacy and educational campaigns emphasizing shared responsibility for road safety. According to the World Health Organization and Department of Health (2021) national survey, Filipino respondents

expressed strong agreement that stricter enforcement of drunk-driving laws can prevent road crashes and save lives. Similarly, Vital Strategies (2024) found that over two-thirds of Filipino adults support stricter monitoring of drunk driving and alcohol sales in commercial areas, reflecting rising public trust in government-led safety programs. However, both studies stress the importance of transparency and fairness in operations, as public skepticism toward corruption or discriminatory enforcement can undermine long-term acceptance.

To sum up, these findings indicate that the Philippines possesses a supportive policy framework and growing social backing for sobriety checkpoints, but continued improvement in operational planning, law enforcement capacity, and public communication is essential to ensure sustained viability and community cooperation.

Support for Enforcement Actions

Public support for enforcement actions plays a central role in determining the viability and long-term sustainability of sobriety checkpoint programs. Research shows that when communities perceive alcohol-impaired driving as a significant threat, their support for enforcement measures including checkpoints tends to increase. Fell et al. (2020) noted that most citizens favor strict drunk-driving enforcement when they understand that such measures directly reduce road crashes and injuries. Also, Mullachery et al. (2022) found that people in high-risk nightlife districts view checkpoints as legitimate enforcement tools necessary for maintaining safety. These findings indicate that strong support for enforcement actions emerges when checkpoints are perceived as protective rather than punitive.

Support for enforcement is also influenced by transparency and fairness in the implementation of sobriety checkpoints. Freeman et al. (2020) emphasized that public willingness to support enforcement actions depends heavily on whether officers conduct operations

respectfully and lawfully. Communities respond positively to checkpoints that follow clear procedures, use standardized testing methods, and avoid discretionary or biased practices. In addition, Morrison et al. (2022) showed that regular communication about the purpose and outcomes of checkpoints significantly enhances community support for strict enforcement activities.

In many regions, public support for enforcement actions increases when the public witnesses tangible reductions in alcohol-related harm. Vital Strategies (2024) reported that Filipino citizens were more supportive of alcohol enforcement policies when exposed to data showing decreases in road crashes. When enforcement actions produce visible improvements, trust and approval naturally rise, strengthening policy acceptance. This suggests that communities value enforcement when its benefits are clearly demonstrated.

Overall, literature consistently shows that support for enforcement actions is strengthened by transparency, fairness, and demonstrable safety benefits. Communities that perceive checkpoints as effective and necessary for public protection express higher acceptance, making enforcement actions more viable, especially in alcohol-dense commercial areas.

Support for Regular Checkpoint Schedules

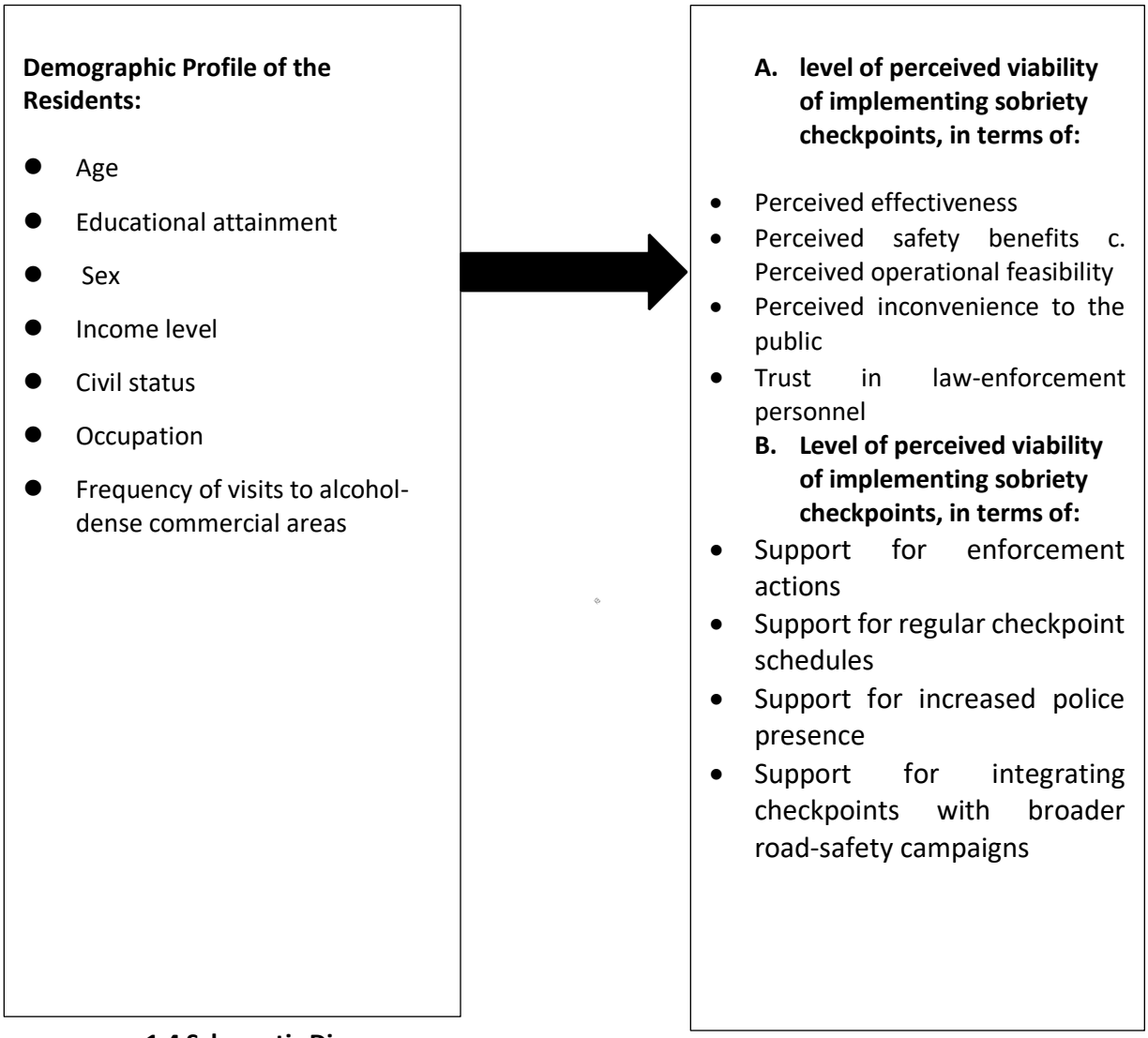
Support for regular checkpoint schedules refers to the public's willingness to accept consistent and routine sobriety checkpoint operations. Regular scheduling is essential for maintaining deterrence, as unpredictable or sporadic enforcement weakens perceived risk among motorists. According to Morrison et al. (2023), predictable but frequent checkpoint operations

reduce alcohol-impaired driving by sustaining the belief that enforcement is ongoing and active. Consistency increases legitimacy, which fosters stronger community support for routine checkpoint implementation.

The public's endorsement of regular checkpoint schedules is also shaped by their perception of operational fairness and efficiency. Fell et al. (2020) found that people are more supportive of regularly scheduled checkpoints when operations minimize delays and clearly communicate the purpose of the intervention. When residents understand that schedules are based on evidence such as peak drinking hours or crash data their willingness to support routine enforcement rises. Similarly, Ferris et al. (2023) highlighted that data-driven scheduling enhances public confidence that checkpoints are strategically implemented rather than arbitrarily conducted.

In high-density entertainment zones, regular checkpoint schedules are often viewed as necessary safety measures. Mullachery et al. (2022) found that residents and business owners in nightlife areas appreciated predictable checkpoint operations because they helped reduce disorder, noise disturbances, and risky driving behaviors. Regularity also reduces public skepticism, as it demonstrates that enforcement is systematic rather than reactionary.

In relation to the study, research indicates that public support for regular checkpoint schedules increases when operations are predictable, evidence-based, and effectively communicated. Consistent enforcement fosters trust and ensures that sobriety checkpoints remain socially acceptable in alcohol-concentrated communities



1.4 Schematic Diagram

Independent Variables **Dependent Variables**

Figure 1. The diagram shows the interplay between the Independent and Dependent variables of the study.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

The study will assess the extent of awareness of the viability and public support towards sobriety checkpoints implementation in alcohol dense areas within Buenavist and Nasipit, Agusan del Norte.

It seeks to answer the following questions:

1. Are there significant differences in perceived viability and public support when respondents are grouped according to their demographic profile, including:

    1.1 Age;

    1.2 Sex;

    1.3 Educational attainment;

    1.4 Income level

    1.5 Occupation;

    1.6 Civil status; and

    1.7 Frequency of visits to alcohol-dense commercial areas?

2. What is the level of perceived viability of implementing sobriety checkpoints in alcohol-dense commercial areas in terms of the following variables:

    2.1 Perceived effectiveness;

    2.2. Perceived safety benefits;

    2.3 Perceived operational feasibility;

    2.4 Perceived inconvenience to the public; and

    2.5 Trust in law-enforcement personnel?

3. What is the level of public support for implementing sobriety checkpoints in alcohol-dense commercial areas in terms of:

    3.1 Support for enforcement actions;

    3.2 Support for regular checkpoint schedules;

    3.3 Support for increased police presence; and

3.4 Support for integrating checkpoints with broader road-safety campaigns?

1.6 Hypothesis

Ho1: There are no significant differences in perceived viability and public support when respondents are grouped according to their demographic profile.

1.7 Definition of Terms

The terms will be operationally defined based on their use in this study.

Age. Refers to the years a resident or a police enforcer exists.

Civil status.

Educational attainment. Refers to the highest educational background a resident or police enforcer has attained.

Frequency of visits to alcohol-dense commercial areas.

Income level. Refers to the level of income a household earns monthly by a respondent.

Occupation. Refers to the type of job a respondent has.

Sex. Refers to whether residents or police enforcers are male or female.

Viability of implementing sobriety checkpoints. Refers to the extent to which the establishment and operation of sobriety checkpoints are feasible, sustainable, and effective within alcohol-dense commercial areas.

Public support for sobriety checkpoints. Refers to the degree of acceptance, approval, and cooperation expressed by community members toward the establishment and enforcement of sobriety checkpoints in alcohol-dense commercial areas.

Scope and Limitation

The study will be conducted along the national highways of Buenavista and Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, where checkpoints are visible and near in alcohol dense areas within the

mentioned municipalities. It will be limited mainly to the selected Barangay residents and police enforcers near or at checkpoints and alcohol dense areas. This will be conducted in the academic year 2025-2026.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

2.1 Research Design

The researchers will use a quantitative research design. Also, researchers will employ the survey-evaluation method, specifically the Likert Scale, to assess the extent of awareness of the

viability and public support towards sobriety checkpoints implementation in alcohol dense areas within Buenavista and Nasipit, Agusan del Norte.

A quantitative research design is appropriate for this study because it seeks to measure, analyze, and statistically interpret relationships between variables (VanderWeele, 2020), specifically between demographic and perceptual factors (e.g., age, gender, education, socioeconomic status, and occupation) and the dependent variables of viability and public support for sobriety checkpoints. Quantitative research focuses on obtaining numerical data from a defined population and using statistical tools to test hypotheses and determine trends, patterns, or correlations.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

The researchers will use a self-made questionnaire that correlates to the objective of the study especially when assessing the viability and public support of sobriety checkpoint implementation.

The questionnaire will have two parts. Part I will be about the demographic profile of residents and police enforcers, which encompasses age, gender, educational attainment, socioeconomic status, and occupation. Whereas, part II will be about the extent of awareness towards the viability and public support of sobriety checkpoint implementation.

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

The study will be conducted among the bars of Buenavista and Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, where checkpoints are visible and near in alcohol dense areas within the mentioned municipalities.

The respondents of this study will consist of bar customers and police enforcers within Buenavista and Nasipit. Participants will be selected through convenience random sampling to allow for accessible and timely data collection. This approach enables the systematic collection of numerical data to evaluate significant differences in perceived viability and public support when respondents are grouped according to their demographic profile. The study aims to capture insights into bridging the gap among the local municipalities which have fewer empirical studies with regard to the latter.

Table 1. Distribution of Bar Customers

Bar	Population	
	F	%
Roadside	100	87.0
Arreza	15	13.0
Total	**115**	**100.0**

Table 2. Distribution of checkpoint officers

Checkpoint	Population	
	F	%
Nasipit	8	50.0
Buenavista	8	50.0
Total	**16**	**100.0**

The tables present the distribution of respondents by location, as part of the study. The estimated populations of customers from Roadside (≈100 patrons) and Arreza (≈15 patrons) were used as bases for determining proportionate target samples. Respondents were then selected on-site through convenience sampling, same well as it goes with the checkpoint officers.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

The following steps will be taken to gather the data:

1. Initially, the researchers will draft a letter asking approval that includes the Distribution of Informed Consent form and the goal of the study. Direct survey will be used to collect the data.
2. Second, the responders will be given the informed consent form by the researchers. The respondents' understanding of and exercise of their right to agree or disagree with the question will be acknowledged.
3. Third, each responder will receive a set of survey questionnaires and a list of questions created by the researchers, which will be verified by the experts.
4. Last but not least, the researchers will provide the respondents with a consent form that outlines the goal of the study, gives them the option to withdraw at any time, and emphasizes that the specific information provided will be kept completely private and accessible only by the researchers. When given permission, the researchers will use statistical treatment, analysis, and interpretation.

Statistical Treatment

The researchers will employ the following statistical techniques to analyze the data effectively. The percentage is the tool used to clarify the data.

Frequency and Percentage. It will answer problem 1 in computing the frequency and percentage of the demographic profile of bar customers and police enforcers.

Mean. It will answer problem numbers 2 & 3in determining the level of perceived viability and public support of implementing sobriety checkpoints in alcohol-dense commercial areas.

Pearson's R Correlational. This tool will address SOP 1, which examines significant differences in perceived viability and public support when respondents are grouped according to their demographic profile.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

This study will be conducted per established ethical research standards and institutional protocols.

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

The researchers were fully protected by their intellectual property rights throughout the research process. The study's data, material, and resources, such as papers, publications, and electronic data, were properly credited and acknowledged to give credit to the original authors. The research excludes plagiarism, unapproved usage, and patent or copyright infringement. All software, frameworks, and tools used for data analysis were open-source, properly licensed, or used with the owners' consent.

B. Informed Consent

To make sure they participated willingly, participants were informed of the potential dangers and rewards, and their written agreement was requested. Additionally, the members

were assured that their involvement was entirely optional and that they would not be penalized for ceasing at any moment.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The fair selection of participants was ensured by choosing individuals directly relevant to the study's objectives, particularly community members and stakeholders with insights or experiences related to the social reintegration of former inmates. This approach upholds justice by including participants whose perspectives accurately represent community attitudes, challenges, and support mechanisms.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

The current study was entirely voluntary. The volunteers were free to decide whether to participate in the survey. Additionally, they were informed of their freedom to leave the learning process without facing any negative repercussions. In this sense, every volunteer consented and was well informed of their rights.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

The researchers took great caution to minimize any possible danger or pain to the volunteers. Participants were advised that no personally or institutionally identifiable information would be disclosed because the topic is cybersecurity threats that may unintentionally straddle the boundaries of delicate organizational issues. The study avoided questions that would cause stress, embarrassment, or damage one's reputation. All interactions were courteous and professional, and it was encouraged to respond comfortably.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

The purpose of this study was to impact society and the academic community. Communities should enhance their understanding and support systems for the social

reintegration of former inmates. The study contributes to social development by highlighting real-life challenges, public attitudes, and the importance of community-based support mechanisms that promote successful reintegration and reduce stigma.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

The fair selection of participants was ensured by choosing individuals directly relevant to the study's objectives, particularly community members and stakeholders with insights or experiences related to the social reintegration of former inmates. This approach upholds justice by including participants whose perspectives accurately represent community attitudes, challenges, and support mechanisms. The selection process for participants was inclusive and aimed to minimize bias or discrimination based on gender, role, or institution. Due to equal participation opportunities for all eligible citizens, this method upheld the ethical trusteeship of justice.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Standardized procedures were used to collect and analyze data to maintain the findings' validity and dependability. The report's authors continuously made great pains to guarantee that the information gathered from the observations was accurately and consistently recorded. To preserve academic integrity and draw reliable conclusions, one must freely recognize and declare any potential biases, restrictions, or misunderstandings.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

To prevent plagiarism, the researchers committed to reporting all findings truthfully, regardless of whether they confirmed the original hypotheses. All information, literature, and materials used in the study were cited correctly and credited. This dedication to truthfulness

improves the study's credibility and allows other researchers or practitioners to confirm the results.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

Every copyrighted and patentable resource used in this study, including published papers, software, and digital tools, was properly cited or used with consent when required. The researchers obtained permission before using or reproducing any intellectual property belonging to others. Regarding open-source resources, the researchers respect academic and legal norms while acknowledging that they are still actively employed in research.

K. Considerations for Human Subjects

Human subjects were treated with dignity, fairness, and respect throughout the research process. To explicitly safeguard the participants, ethical measures were put in place to guarantee their welfare, right to privacy, and rights as study participants, all covered by the ethics Saint Michael College of Caraga has authorized. No personal identifiers were gathered during the data collection process to ensure anonymity.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Other Technologies

To achieve and maintain the integrity of the data while preserving its authenticity, any artificial intelligence (AI) technologies or digital platforms utilized in the data analysis, transcription, or organization process were employed responsibly. In each instance, researchers used human judgment to confirm AI-assisted results and avoided prejudice, data manipulation, or ethical transgressions.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval: The Saint Michael College of Caraga Ethics Review Committee provided ethical clearance and approval before the research study's execution. The study adhered to the national data privacy law, the institution's moral standards, and the international ethics in research approach. This guaranteed that the study project moved forward with professionalism, academic integrity, and transparency.